

TEACHABLE MOMENTS

WHY MOST LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES ARE MISSED



TIMING AND APPROACH MATTER MORE THAN INTENTION.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Why Most Learning Opportunities Are Missed

← You are here

02

What a Teachable Moment Actually is

Coming up.

03

Why Kids Struggle to Connect the Dots

Coming up.

04

The Parent's Role in the Room

Coming up.

05

Putting It Into Practice

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

MOST PARENTS MISS
TEACHABLE MOMENTS.
NOT BECAUSE THEY
DON'T CARE BUT
BECAUSE OF TIMING.

Intent is not the issue. A parent who jumps in too fast, in the wrong moment, with the right message still loses the lesson.

— · TIMING IS THE LESSON

WHAT A TEACHABLE MOMENT IS

A PAUSE.
A QUESTION.
A CONNECTION.

→ It is NOT: a lecture, correction session, or post-game analysis while emotions are raw

→ It IS: a conversation that helps the athlete reflect after her nervous system has settled

→ The gap between those two things is where most parents get stuck

— IF SHE CAN'T THINK, SHE CAN'T LEARN.

05 · THE NERVOUS SYSTEM PROBLEM

WHY SHE CAN'T HEAR YOU

FIGHT OR FLIGHT

After competition, her nervous system is still activated. Logic isn't accessible yet.



EMOTIONAL OVERLOAD

Embarrassment, exhaustion, and frustration block the part of the brain that processes feedback.

THE WINDOW

The teachable window opens after the nervous system settles — not during the storm.

06 · CREATING THE CONDITIONS

WHAT PARENTS CAN CONTROL

YOUR TIMING

Wait. Let the car ride be quiet. Create space before you create the conversation.

YOUR TONE

Curious questions land differently than corrective statements.

YOUR PATIENCE

The lesson doesn't have to happen today to matter for the season.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS · COME BACK TO IT

A GOOD LESSON IN
THE WRONG MOMENT
TEACHES NOTHING.
A SIMPLE QUESTION
AT THE RIGHT TIME
CHANGES EVERYTHING.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— TIMING IS THE LESSON

THIS WEEK

PRACTICE THE PAUSE THIS WEEK

✓ After the next hard moment, stay silent for 20 minutes longer than feels comfortable.

✓ Notice what your athlete does with that silence does she start talking on her own?

✓ When you do open a conversation, start with one question only.

✓ Write down the question before you ask it so you know it's curious, not corrective.



TEACHABLE MOMENTS

WHAT A TEACHABLE
MOMENT ACTUALLY IS

02

NOT A LECTURE. NOT A DEBRIEF. A CONNECTION.



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A TEACHABLE MOMENT
IS NOT A CORRECTION.
IT'S A CONNECTION
BETWEEN A CHOICE
AND AN OUTCOME.

The difference sounds small. The impact is enormous. One creates compliance; the other creates awareness.

— CONNECTION BEFORE CORRECTION

THE ANATOMY

FOUR PARTS. ONE MOMENT.

- The trigger: something happened that has learning in it
- The window: the nervous system has settled enough to think
- The question: one open question that invites reflection
- The space: silence that lets the answer emerge don't fill it

— ASK. THEN WAIT. THE LESSON LIVES IN HER ANSWER.

05 · THE TRIGGER

WHAT QUALIFIES

A MISTAKE

A missed set, a blown assignment, a hard loss all fertile ground.

A SURPRISE WIN

Unexpected success has as much to teach as failure.

AN EMOTIONAL REACTION

Frustration, tears, or shutdown after competition is a signal, not a problem to fix.



WHAT TO ACTUALLY ASK

NOT: 'WHY DID YOU DO THAT?'

This is accusatory. It triggers defense, not reflection.

TRY: 'WHAT DID YOU NOTICE?'

This is curious. It opens thinking instead of closing it.

OR: 'WHAT WOULD YOU DO DIFFERENTLY?'

Future-focused questions build the mental skill of self-correction.

02



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

ASK ONE QUESTION.
WAIT FOR THE ANSWER.
THAT'S THE WHOLE
TEACHABLE MOMENT.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— CONNECTION BEFORE CORRECTION

THIS WEEK

PREPARE YOUR QUESTION BEFORE THE NEXT COMPETITION.

✓ Write down one question you'd ask after a tough moment make it curious, not corrective.

✓ Practice the question in your head so it's ready when the moment arrives.

✓ After the next competition, wait until the car is quiet before using it.

✓ Write down what she said. You'll want to reference it later.



TEACHABLE MOMENTS

WHY KIDS STRUGGLE
TO CONNECT THE DOTS

03

THEY DON'T LACK INFORMATION. THEY LACK AWARENESS.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

SHE KNOWS WHAT
SHE'S SUPPOSED TO DO.
SHE JUST CAN'T CONNECT
CHOICE TO OUTCOME
YET.

Knowing something intellectually is not the same as feeling its impact. That connection has to be taught through experience, not instruction.

— AWARENESS IS A SKILL, NOT A GIVEN

THE AWARENESS GAP

INFORMATION VS. AWARENESS.

→ She knows: hydration matters, rest affects performance, focus helps

→ She doesn't feel: the direct link between her choices and her results

→ The gap: no one helped her connect the dots through experience

— REFLECTION BUILDS THE BRIDGE BETWEEN KNOWING AND FEELING.

05 · HOW AWARENESS DEVELOPS

THE EXPERIENCE LOOP

MAKE THE CHOICE

Let her choose good and bad without intervening.

EXPERIENCE THE RESULT

She feels the natural consequence of the choice in her performance.

REFLECT ON THE CONNECTION

A simple question post-experience builds the bridge: 'what do you think caused that?'



06 · THE PARENT TRAP

WHAT SLOWS IT DOWN

RESCUING TOO FAST

Stepping in before she feels the result removes the lesson.

EXPLAINING INSTEAD OF ASKING

Telling her what caused it gives her information. Asking her builds awareness.

EXPECTING IT TO BE FAST

Awareness develops over a season, not a weekend.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE CONNECTION SHE
MAKES HERSELF
IS THE ONE THAT
CHANGES HER BEHAVIOR.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— LET HER FEEL IT FIRST

THIS WEEK

CREATE ONE AWARENESS EXPERIMENT THIS WEEK.

✓ Pick one choice-outcome connection to focus on this week.

✓ Let the experience happen without intervening.

✓ Debrief with one question: 'what do you think caused that?'

✓ Let her answer stand don't correct or add to it.



TEACHABLE MOMENTS

THE PARENT'S ROLE IN THE ROOM



PRESENCE WITHOUT INTERFERENCE IS THE HARDEST SKILL IN YOUTH SPORTS.



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THE MOST POWERFUL
THING A PARENT CAN DO
IN A TEACHABLE MOMENT
IS ALMOST NOTHING.

Presence. Calm. One question. That's the whole job. Most parents can't resist doing more and that's where the lesson disappears.

— LESS IS MORE WHEN IT COMES TO TEACHING

THE PARENT'S ROLE

NOT THE TEACHER. THE CONDITIONS.

→ Your job: create the emotional safety for the lesson to land

→ Her job: do the learning

→ The line: when you cross into teaching, you end the teachable moment

— YOUR CALM IS THE CONTAINER THE LESSON LIVES IN.

05 · WHAT CROSSES THE LINE

WHEN PARENTS OVER-FUNCTION

EXPLAINING THE LESSON

If you explain what she should have learned, she doesn't have to learn it herself.

FOLLOWING UP REPEATEDLY

Reminding her of the lesson after it happened turns it from hers to yours.

MAKING IT A PATTERN

'You always do this' turns a single moment into an identity label.



06 · STAYING IN YOUR ROLE

THE THREE TOOLS

SILENCE

The most underused parenting tool in youth sports. It gives her space to think.

ONE QUESTION

Not two. Not three. One. And then wait.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

'That sounded hard' is sometimes the only thing the moment needs from you.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

YOUR CALM AND YOUR
SILENCE ARE THE CONDITIONS
THE LESSON NEEDS
TO ACTUALLY LAND.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— CREATE THE CONTAINER



THIS WEEK

PRACTICE ONE TOOL THIS WEEK.

✓ Choose one: silence, one question, or acknowledgement and use only that after the next hard moment.

✓ Notice how your athlete responds when you do less.

✓ Write down what she said or did that surprised you.

✓ Reflect: where did you want to say more but didn't? What happened because you held back?



TEACHABLE MOMENTS

PUTTING IT
INTO PRACTICE

OS

THE TEACHABLE MOMENT FRAMEWORK IN REAL COMPETITION.



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TEACHABLE MOMENTS
DON'T HAPPEN ON
YOUR SCHEDULE.
YOU HAVE TO BE
READY BEFORE THEY ARRIVE.

The parents who use these moments most effectively prepared their response before the emotion was in the room.

— PREPARE THE RESPONSE BEFORE THE MOMENT

THE FULL FRAMEWORK

BEFORE. DURING. AFTER.

→ Before: decide your one question in advance for each competition

→ During: regulate your own emotions your calm creates the window

→ After: wait for the nervous system to settle, then use the question once

— A PREPARED PARENT CREATES MORE LEARNING IN ONE SEASON THAN AN UNPREPARED ONE DOES IN FIVE.

PREPARING YOURSELF

WRITE THE QUESTION

Pick your one post-game question before you get in the car. Have it ready.

SET YOUR INTENTION

Before the match: 'my job today is to be regulated and present not to coach.'

KNOW YOUR TRIGGERS

What moment will make you want to intervene? Name it before it happens.



06 · AFTER THE MOMENT

CLOSING THE LOOP

THE 24-HOUR RULE

Some lessons need a day to settle before they can be named. Wait when in doubt.

WRITE IT DOWN

Keep a simple note of what teachable moments you used this season.

TRACK HER GROWTH

Look back at the beginning of the season vs. now. The awareness gap closing is the proof.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE PARENT WHO
WAS READY TO BE
CALM BEFORE IT
GOT HARD IS THE
ONE WHO TAUGHT
SOMETHING REAL.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— PREPARE BEFORE YOU NEED IT

BUILD YOUR SEASON TEACHABLE MOMENT PRACTICE.

✓ Write one question for each of the following: a loss, a mistake, a strong performance.

✓ Before the next competition, set your intention for what your role is in writing.

✓ After the next hard moment, try the framework: wait, one question, let it land.

✓ At the end of the season, look back at your notes. What did she learn because you were ready?

